

Defensible evidence

Why our reports refuse to guess - and why that is the point on a job where the document ends up on a table between two parties.

THE PROBLEM WITH A CONFIDENT ANSWER

Software that reads photographs will give you **an answer for every photograph**, because a blank reads as the tool having failed. So the report looks complete, and one of its lines is a guess. On a schedule of condition or a due-diligence report, that is the line the other side finds.

WHAT WE DO INSTEAD

It will not guess

Where the evidence does not support a judgement, the item is marked **not assessed** and says so on the page. It does not resolve to a pass.

It may only cite what is on its list - **12 Approved Documents, 6 British and EN standards, 6 HSE instruments**. Nothing off that list is ever cited; if nothing fits, it cites nothing.

A person has to resolve it

The report **cannot be issued** while anything is unresolved. A named person confirms, corrects or deletes each item, and every item needs a trade before it can go.

Publishing freezes it: the issued version keeps its reference and date, and a change starts a new version rather than editing the old one.

WHY IT MATTERS HERE

A snagging list is a to-do list: speed is the point. A **schedule of condition or a dilapidations report is not a list, it is a position** - used at lease exit, in negotiation, in provision reporting, sometimes in front of a lawyer. One invented line and the document stops being evidence. An item that openly says *not assessed, and here is why*, resolved by a person, with the photograph and its capture details attached, is what survives being challenged.

WHAT HOLDS IT UP

RULE	IN THE REPORT
Not assessed	Anything the evidence cannot support is flagged for a person, never resolved to a pass
Citation ceiling	Only the listed standards may be cited - no invented clauses, no guessed paragraph numbers
Evidence attached	Every finding sits on its photograph, and every photograph carries its own time, place and capture details
Frozen on issue	The issued version never changes afterwards; a correction becomes a new version with its own reference

WHAT IT DOES NOT DO

Read this before relying on the output

- It does not decide engineering. It describes what the photograph shows; severity and sign-off are a person's call.
- It is not a drawing tool - no CAD, no BIM - and it does not replace a measured survey.
- It cannot assess what was not photographed, and it says so rather than filling the gap.
- It sends nothing by itself, and it is not a certification of compliance.

If a report has to survive being challenged, the honest blank beats the confident guess.

Photographs in, a referenced report out - drafted by the machine, resolved and issued by a person.

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